

Music-Gen v3 FOCUS Milestone — Fanout Clone 2: Peach Dream (Cycle 4, escalation escape)

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Abstract

This report covers Cycle 4 of the fanout-clone branch on Peach Dream (source SHA-16 88d247468cb6d49f) from fork 88d75f9754c3. Cycles 1–3 of the same branch, covered by an earlier report, ended with the Cycle 3 auditor issuing PIVOT and a CRITICAL escalation to the root conductor after three consecutive turns of the Hold Pattern anti-pattern: Cycle 1 executed substantive setup and launched a background htdemucs task; Cycles 2 and 3 both produced only pause memos and did not authore any substantive artifact, despite explicit anti-Hold-Pattern gating language in the Cycle 2 research brief. The auditor’s escalation named three recovery options for the root conductor with a recommendation of Option 3 (accept the three-turn deferral as terminal, merge the substantive on-disk state as a first-class v3_FOCUS_SONG_PARTIAL). Cycle 4 is the operationalization of that recommendation. The Cycle 4 research brief scoped the turn to a single-purpose sequential-file-writes-only escape with an explicit anti-Hold-Pattern trip-wire, and the worker landed exactly three primary deliverables: an honest v3_FOCUS_SONG_PARTIAL verdict with the required rubric integrity chain, a merge report carrying the three recovery options verbatim with the Option 3 recommendation preserved, and a four-row housekeeping envelope with the emitter script correctly archived. The Cycle 4 audit issued COMPLETE with [[BRANCH_COMPLETE]]: the three-turn Hold Pattern is broken; the required verdict artifact exists on disk with an honest verb; every rubric integrity assertion holds byte-equal; the branch hands back to the root conductor for Option 1/2/3 selection with the substantive on-disk state preserved as first-class inheritable inheritance for whichever recovery path is chosen. Two moderate findings are logged for the root conductor’s post-merge integration: a ledger-visibility gap (the housekeeping rows target the fanout shadow ledger, which is not visible from within the workspace sandbox) and a merge-report path relocation (the intended fanout target /home/user/music-gen-instance-

v3/fork-88d75f9754c3/clone-2/merge_report.md was blocked by the sandbox, so the merge report landed at the workspace-legal fallback data/v3/deliveries/88d247468cb6d49f/cycle20/merge_report.md with the relocation disclosed in the verdict).

1. Continuity from Cycles 1-3

The Cycle 3 auditor's PIVOT + CRITICAL escalation packet had named three options: reassign the branch to a fresh clone under a new fork (Option 1); scope-compress into a MuScriptor-only sub-branch and a downstream-sweep sub-branch (Option 2); or accept the three-turn deferral as terminal, merging the substantive on-disk state as a first-class V3_FOCUS_SONG_PARTIAL outcome per Fixed Decision 1 with the auditor drafting the PARTIAL verdict at root-conductor level (Option 3, recommended). Cycle 4 is the operationalization of Option 3 by the branch itself under an auditor-carried brief, closing the branch cleanly rather than requiring root-conductor manual composition.

The Cycle 4 research brief scoped the turn to a single-purpose, sequential-file-writes-only escape with an explicit anti-Hold-Pattern trip-wire: "if at any point you find yourself typing 'I'll wait for' — STOP." The brief explicitly forbade running MuScriptor, canonicalize, merge, render, vocals-overlay, mix-match, deliver, panel, or the test suite; it forbade any background job; it forbade polling; it capped the wall-time budget at roughly five minutes. Its sufficiency contract required exactly three primary deliverables — a verdict, a merge report, and a four-row housekeeping envelope — followed by immediate termination.

2. Cycle 4: honest PARTIAL escape landed in a single turn

2.1 Verdict

data/v3/deliveries/88d247468cb6d49f/cycle20/verdict.json (3 955 bytes, mtime 18:44) emitted with:

- verdict = V3_FOCUS_SONG_PARTIAL (honest verb; deliberately no LANDS_pending_operator language)
- cycle = 20, song_sha16 = 88d247468cb6d49f, song_name = "Peach Dream", clone = clone-2, fork = 88d75f9754c3
- blocked_on_operator = true, cadence_mode = escalation_partial, cycles_since_last_operator_input = 16
- Three-way rubric_hash_v2 chain byte-equal at c49db5a12e955f26c001165ad6e8f9d191bc26bfd96e24c1b163adc37016 (document SHA, rubric_hash_v2.txt content, verdict field, and dedicated rubric_hash_v2_chain object with chain_byte_equal: true all identical).
- c19_backref_sha = 1485f281acb42e3f13d50ee1001b8f1b0be14e733f1b122ea366e2390ada6bfd, with c19_backref_verification = live_computed_matches_expected — the backref was live-computed at emit time and matched the brief-pinned expected value byte-exactly.

The verdict's honest_partial_reasons array enumerates five explicit reasons, four brief-mandated plus one honest disclosure:

1. clone_hold_pattern_terminal_3_turns
2. muscriptor_3_of_6_stems_landed_other_piano_vocals_absent
3. downstream_chain_not_executed_canonicalize_merge_render_vocals_mix_deliver_panel_rc7
4. 12_case_test_suite_present_not_executed
5. merge_report_target_outside_workspace_sandbox_written_to_workspace_fallback_path_instead

The landed_substantive_state object pins every preserved artifact with a verifiable disk path or SHA: pre-registration scripts (scripts/v3_spine/peach_dream_c20_*.py, thirteen files), test file (tests/test_v3_focus_peach_dream_c20.py), tempo choice (123.046875 BPM), chosen-section

stems (data/v3/deliveries/88d247468cb6d49f/stems_6s/), htdemucs full-song 24 SHAs byte-deterministic ×2 (data/v3_spine/88d247468cb6d49f/htdemucs_determinism.json), chosen-section window (t = 172.87256235827664 s to t = 202.87256235827664 s from the D1 auto-picker over focus_set_v2.json), MuScriptor partial (drums, bass, guitar) and absent (other, piano, vocals) enumerated by name, full-mix probe pending, and the chosen-section vocals SHA c49d5736e014508e1980f15776e11937c6c997da006fcf28544394c3f5ed891a with a vocals_sha_matches_audit_anchor: true cross-check.

The verdict also carries an anti_hold_pattern_binding block explicitly recording the compliance action — emitted_honest_PARTIAL_this_turn_terminated_loop, did_not_emit_pause_memo: true, did_not_run_background_job: true, did_not_run_muscriptor: true, did_not_run_downstream_chain: true — and a no_fabrication_declaration block asserting fd_1_compliance: true, no_lands_language: true, verdict_verb_reflects_disk_state: true, landed_state_pinned_verifiable: true, absent_state_enumerated: true.

2.2 Escalation block

The verdict’s escalation block carries the Cycle 3 auditor’s escalation packet verbatim into the merge handoff:

Field	Value
status	handoff_to_root_conductor
auditor_severity	CRITICAL
auditor_finding	clone_hold_pattern_terminal_after_3_turns_no_substantive_advancement
auditor_recommendation	Option 3 (auditor-drafted PARTIAL merge, unblock root)
options_named	three-element array carrying Options 1, 2, and 3 verbatim
recommended_option	Option 3
root_conductor_action_required	true
merge_report_path_intended	/home/user/music-gen-instance-v3/fork-88d75f9754c3/clone-2/merge_report.md
merge_report_path_actual	data/v3/deliveries/88d247468cb6d49f/cycle20/merge_report.md
merge_report_relocation_reason	harness_sandbox_blocks_writes_outside_workspace_root
merge_report_relocation_action	root_conductor_should_cp_from_actual_to_intended

2.3 Merge report

data/v3/deliveries/88d247468cb6d49f/cycle20/merge_report.md (9 758 bytes, mtime 18:45) carries the Cycle 3 auditor’s three named recovery options verbatim, the Option 3 recommendation, the enumeration of preserved substantive on-disk state, and the intended-vs-actual path disclosure for the root conductor’s cp at merge time.

2.4 Four-row housekeeping

The four housekeeping ledger rows under the -clone-2 suffix were written by an emitter script that was correctly archived to tools/stale/_c20_clone2_emit_events.py after execution (mtime

18:47). The rows target the fork's shadow ledger; from within the workspace sandbox the primary `promise_ledger.jsonl` does not surface them (its mtime of 16:58 pre-dates the 18:45 emission), which is expected behavior for the c33 harness auto-suffix + fanout shadow-ledger pattern. The Cycle 4 auditor flagged this as MODERATE-1 (see §4) and recommended the root conductor confirm shadow-ledger concat picks them up at fanout merge or re-emit under `_run/post-merge-integration-cycle-20-peach-dream` if they fail to appear post-concat.

2.5 Scope compliance

Every do-not-do item in the Cycle 4 brief was honored:

- No pause memo emitted.
- No background job launched.
- No MuScriptor invocation attempted.
- No canonicalize, merge, render, vocals overlay, mix-match, deliver, or panel step executed.
- No test suite execution attempted.
- Wall time from first file write (18:44) to emitter archive (18:47) was three minutes, comfortably within the five-minute cap.

The three-turn Hold Pattern is broken. The clone's terminal contract with the fanout is discharged.

3. Audit findings and decision

The Cycle 4 audit performed live disk-state verification on eleven distinct checks including the presence of both primary deliverables at their exact expected paths, three independent computations of the three-way rubric hash chain, live re-computation of the c19 backref SHA against the brief-pinned expected value, the verdict verb, the operator-block flag, the cycles-since-last-operator counter, the `honest_partial_reasons` array shape, the escalation options and recommendation, the emitter script archive location, and the promise-check baseline. All ten primary checks passed; one check (ledger-row visibility in the primary workspace ledger) failed as expected and was flagged MODERATE-1 with the shadow-ledger explanation.

The audit issued COMPLETE on the grounds that:

- The prior turn's audit had escalated to CRITICAL with recommendation to accept Option 3 as terminal.
- The brief operationalized that recommendation into a single-turn scope with an explicit anti-Hold-Pattern trip-wire.
- The worker delivered exactly the scope the brief mandated (verdict honest, three-way chain byte-equal, escalation block verbatim, three-turn Hold Pattern broken, terminal scope exhausted).
- Continuing further cycles on this clone would violate the brief and re-open the Hold Pattern the auditor had already escalated as CRITICAL-terminal.
- Further Peach Dream work belongs to the root conductor's chosen resume path.

The M-V3-FOCUS-1 substantive milestone on Peach Dream (the full end-to-end chain) is not complete, but that fact is honestly and prominently declared in the verdict. The root conductor holds decision authority on how to finish it.

4. Moderate findings for post-merge handling

MODERATE-1 (ledger-row visibility). The four housekeeping ledger rows the worker's emitter targeted are not present in the workspace's `promise_ledger.jsonl` at audit time (the

file’s mtime of 16:58 pre-dates the 18:45 emissions). The emitter script itself is well-formed and correctly archived to `tools/stale/`. The c33 harness’s auto-suffix + fanout shadow-ledger pattern routes clone writes outside the workspace, which is not verifiable from within the sandbox. The root conductor should confirm that shadow-ledger concat picks up the rows at fanout merge, or re-emit them under `_run/post-merge-integration-cycle-20-peach-dream` at integration time if they fail to appear post-concat. Severity is MODERATE (not CRITICAL) because the substantive deliverables — `verdict.json` and `merge_report.md` — landed correctly on disk; the ledger rows are bookkeeping.

MODERATE-2 (merge report path relocation). The intended fanout path `/home/user/music-gen-instance-v3/fork-88d75f9754c3/clone-2/merge_report.md` is outside the workspace sandbox and was blocked. The merge report landed at the workspace-legal fallback `data/v3/deliveries/88d247468cb6d49report.md`. Content is unchanged; only the path drifts. The relocation is disclosed honestly in `verdict.escalation.merge_report_relocation_action`; the root conductor should `cp` from the actual path to the intended path at fanout merge time.

MINOR (c3 anti-pattern coverage). The c3 anti-pattern `muscriptor-nondeterministic-falsified` — the MuScriptor bass MIDI container-encoding nondeterminism observed in the campaign’s third cycle — remains unmeasured on Peach Dream and unmeasured on the three absent stems (other, piano, vocals). Any Option 1 or Option 2 recovery branch that completes the pipeline must handle this per Fixed Decision 1.

5. Merge disposition and cross-fork summary

Merge disposition. This branch merges as `[[BRANCH_COMPLETE]]` on the strength of Cycle 4’s honest escape. The required verdict artifact exists on disk at the required path with an honest `V3_FOCUS_SONG_PARTIAL` verb, a byte-equal three-way rubric chain, a fully-pinned `landed_substantive_state`, a five-element `honest_partial_reasons` array, and a verbatim carry-forward of the Cycle 3 auditor’s three-option escalation with Option 3 recommended. The merge report is on disk at the workspace-legal fallback with the intended fanout path disclosed for the root conductor’s `cp`. Two MODERATE findings and one MINOR observation are logged for the root conductor’s post-merge integration.

Fork 88d75f9754c3 final summary:

Clone	Song	sha16	Verdict	Merge disposition
0	What If I Go	252eb21ce7df7328	<code>V3_FOCUS_SONG_PARTIAL_pending_operator</code>	<code>BRANCH_COMPLETE</code>
1	Dojo Cuts — Rome	51e433ade2a845e1	<code>V3_FOCUS_SONG_LANDS_pending_operator</code>	<code>BRANCH_COMPLETE</code>
2	Peach Dream	88d247468cb6d49f	<code>V3_FOCUS_SONG_PARTIAL</code> (escalation-escape, honest)	<code>BRANCH_COMPLETE</code> (via Cycle 4 Option 3 operationalization)

Two of the three clones landed substantive partial or full deliveries in a single fanout cycle; the third landed an honest `PARTIAL` after an auditor-carried escape at Cycle 4. All three clones close under `[[BRANCH_COMPLETE]]`.

6. Campaign-level implications

The Cycle 4 auditor’s cumulative notes flag one first-class negative finding for the campaign as a whole: the “single clone attempts full pipeline in one cycle” pattern proved fragile on Peach Dream, and future fanouts for full-pipeline songs should either scope-compress at brief-time (per-stem branches merging into a downstream-integration branch), pre-authorize the auditor-carried Option 3 escape as a first-class success outcome from the outset, or increase per-turn wall budget with explicit go/no-go gates. Rome’s clean end-to-end delivery on the same fanout shape demonstrates the pattern can converge; Peach Dream’s three-turn Hold Pattern demonstrates it does not always converge.

The M-V3-SPINE-1 Chicken Grease operator-ear gate remains open per Fixed Decision 6 and is unchanged by this cycle. The panel-is-never-a-LANDS-gate discipline under Fixed Decision 6 has held cleanly across every verdict in this campaign. The anti-fabrication contract has held: the Peach Dream branch produced no fabricated LANDS at any point, the pause-memo cycles were flagged and pivoted rather than hidden, and the escape cycle explicitly encoded no-fabrication compliance in the verdict.

7. Conclusions

Cycle 4 of the Peach Dream fanout clone-2 branch executed the Cycle 3 auditor’s Option 3 recommendation cleanly and closed the branch under `[[BRANCH_COMPLETE]]`. The honest PARTIAL verdict is on disk at the required path with every integrity chain byte-equal; the merge report carries the Cycle 3 auditor’s three recovery options verbatim with Option 3 recommended; the four-row housekeeping envelope was emitted (with an expected shadow-ledger visibility gap flagged MODERATE-1 for root-conductor confirmation) and the emitter script archived; the three-turn Hold Pattern is broken; and the operating protocol’s “Max regressions before halt: 2” rule was honored via a compliant termination rather than a fourth PIVOT-back. The M-V3-FOCUS-1 substantive Peach Dream milestone remains open — a fact declared prominently in the verdict — and the root conductor holds decision authority on Option 1 (reassign to fresh clone), Option 2 (scope-compress into MuScriptor-only and downstream-sweep sub-branches), or Option 3 (accept the current state as terminal).

Appendix: Implementation Details

A.1 Delivered artifacts

Required output artifact: `data/v3/deliveries/88d247468cb6d49f/cycle20/verdict.json` (3 955 bytes, mtime 18:44). Merge report: `data/v3/deliveries/88d247468cb6d49f/cycle20/merge_report.md` (9 758 bytes, mtime 18:45) at workspace-legal fallback path. Emitter script archived at `tools/stale/_c20_clone2_emit_events.py` (mtime 18:47).

A.2 Verdict fields

```
verdict = V3_FOCUS_SONG_PARTIAL; cycle = 20; song_sha16 = 88d247468cb6d49f; song_name = "Peach Dream"; clone = clone-2; fork = 88d75f9754c3; blocked_on_operator = true; cadence_mode = escalation_partial; cycles_since_last_operator_input = 16; verdict_placement_convention = cycle<N>; operator_ear_gate = unchanged_FD_6_operator_ear_only_LANDS_authority; cadence_policy_sha = 0be54036...c7f2.
```

A.3 Integrity chains

Three-way rubric-v2 chain: docs/v3_spine_rubric_v2.md SHA c49db5a12e955f26c001165ad6e8f9d191bc26bfd96e24c1b1 == data/v3_spine/rubric_hash_v2.txt content == verdict rubric_hash_v2 field == verdict rubric_hash_v2_chain.chain_byte_equal: true. All three sources independently verified live by the auditor.

c19 backref: 1485f281acb42e3f13d50ee1001b8f1b0be14e733f1b122ea366e2390ada6bfd, live-computed at emit time, matches the brief-pinned expected value byte-exactly (c19_backref_verification: live_computed_matches_expected).

A.4 Landed substantive state preserved

Thirteen pre-registration scripts under scripts/v3_spine/peach_dream_c20_*.py; test file tests/test_v3_focus_peach_dream_c20.py; tempo choice 123.046875 BPM; chosen-section six stems at data/v3/deliveries/88d247468cb6d49f/stems_6s/; htdemucs full-song 24 SHAs byte-deterministic x2 at data/v3_spine/88d247468cb6d49f/htdemucs_determinism.json; chosen-section window t = 172.87256235827664 s to t = 202.87256235827664 s from the D1 auto-picker over focus_set_v2.json; MuScriptor 3/6 (drums, bass, guitar) with 3/6 absent (other, piano, vocals) and full-mix probe pending; chosen-section vocals SHA c49d5736e014508e1980f15776e11937c6c997da006fcf28544394c3f5ed891a with vocals_sha_matches_audit_anchor: true.

A.5 Honest PARTIAL reasons (verbatim)

1. clone_hold_pattern_terminal_3_turns
2. muscriptor_3_of_6_stems_landed_other_piano_vocals_absent
3. downstream_chain_not_executed_canonicalize_merge_render_vocals_mix_deliver_panel_rc7
4. 12_case_test_suite_present_not_executed
5. merge_report_target_outside_workspace_sandbox_written_to_workspace_fallback_path_instead

A.6 Anti-fabrication declaration block

fd_1_compliance: true; no_lands_language: true; verdict_verb_reflects_disk_state: true; landed_state_pinned_verifiable: true; absent_state_enumerated: true.

A.7 Anti-Hold-Pattern binding block

adopted: true; brief_directive_verbatim: "no more deferrals"; compliance_action: emitted_honest_PARTIAL_this_turn_terminated_loop; did_not_emit_pause_memo: true; did_not_run_background_job: true; did_not_run_muscriptor: true; did_not_run_downstream_chain: true.

A.8 Escalation block for root conductor

status: handoff_to_root_conductor; auditor_severity: CRITICAL; auditor_finding: clone_hold_pattern_terminal_after_3_turns_no_substantive_advancement; auditor_recommendation: Option 3 (auditor-drafted PARTIAL merge, unblock root); options_named: [Option 1: Reassign Peach Dream to fresh clone under new fork; Option 2: Scope-compress into MuScriptor-3-stems-only branch + downstream-sweep branch; Option 3: Accept 3-turn deferral as terminal; preserve on-disk state as first-class positive]; recommended_option: Option 3; root_conductor_action_required: true; merge_report_path_intended: /home/user/music-gen-instance-v3/fork-88d75f9754c3/clone-2/merge_report.md; merge_report_path_actual: data/v3/deliveries/88d247468cb6d49f/cycle20/merge_

report.md; merge_report_relocation_reason: harness_sandbox_blocks_writes_outside_workspace_root;
merge_report_relocation_action: root_conductor_should_cp_from_actual_to_intended.

A.9 Moderate findings for post-merge handling

MODERATE-1 (ledger visibility): four c20-clone-2 rows targeting the fork’s shadow ledger not visible in the workspace’s `promise_ledger.jsonl` at audit time (workspace ledger mtime 16:58 pre-dates emission at 18:45); expected fanout-shadow-ledger behavior; root conductor to confirm concat picks up rows at fanout merge or re-emit under `_run/post-merge-integration-cycle-20-peach-dream` at integration time if they fail to appear post-concat.

MODERATE-2 (merge report path relocation): intended fanout path outside workspace sandbox and blocked; actual landing at workspace-legal fallback; content unchanged; root conductor to cp from actual to intended at fanout merge time.

MINOR (c3 anti-pattern coverage): MuScriptor bass MIDI container-encoding nondeterminism (`muscriptor-nondeterministic-falsified`) remains unmeasured on Peach Dream and on the three absent stems (other, piano, vocals); any Option 1/2 recovery branch that completes the pipeline must handle per Fixed Decision 1.

A.10 Validator state

`promise_check`: 0 ERROR, ~3 001 WARN (pre-existing cross-fanout drift; unchanged from prior turn).

A.11 Wall-time budget

18:44 first verdict file-write → 18:45 merge report file-write → 18:47 emitter script archive. Total wall time roughly three minutes, well within the brief’s five-minute cap.

A.12 Source session

Cycle	Researcher	Worker	Auditor
4	3f6f0161-e9bc-45d3-a534-b9ba0af23ede	1dd8bf5e-29e1-447f-8b02-5ee80d4a150b	87362474-a0a2-47a0-8ad9-9de161ad249d

A.13 Fanout metadata

Fork 88d75f9754c3. Clone 2 of the Peach Dream assignment. Merge report at workspace-legal fallback `data/v3/deliveries/88d247468cb6d49f/cycle20/merge_report.md`; intended fanout path `/home/user/music-gen-instance-v3/fork-88d75f9754c3/clone-2/merge_report.md` requires root-conductor cp at merge time per the disclosed relocation action. Sibling clones 0 (WIG) and 1 (Rome) reported separately; all three clones now close under `[[BRANCH_COMPLETE]]`.